

What is the *halachic* status of pasteurized wine? Wine is usually pasteurized through a process called “flash pasteurization,” where it is heated to a temperature between 65°C and 75°C (149°F to 167°F) for a very short time, usually only a few minutes or even seconds, in order to kill bacteria. Is such wine considered *mevushal*?

RSZA in 36) (מנחת שלמה (קמא-כה) explains that although wine reaches *yad soledes bo* (according to many opinions) during pasteurization, it still may not be considered *mevushal*. The reason is that the definition of *mevushal* wine is not just that it reaches a certain temperature, but rather that it begins to steam, thereby causing a reduction in volume and a change in taste, which occurs only when it begins to evaporate. However, pasteurization is performed in a unique way that prevents the wine from evaporating (since it is heated in airtight pipes for only for a few seconds). Furthermore, it is almost impossible to distinguish pasteurized wine from regular wine, even for a wine connoisseur.

Rav Elyashiv in (ח"א-עה) (קובץ תשובות) also *passkins* that pasteurization is not considered *mevushal*, but for a different reason. He explains that according to the רא"ש, *mevushal* wine was never included in the *gezeirah* because it was not common, but if most wines today are pasteurized, they are considered common and are retroactively included in the original *gezeirah* of Chazal. (Rav Elyashiv disagrees with the above explanation of RSZA, who maintained that even if *mevushal* wine is common nowadays, Chazal's leniency still remains in place, since prohibiting it today would effectively constitute creating a new *gezeirah*). The (ח"ב כ"ט) (אור לציון) also does not consider pasteurization as *bishul*.

In contrast, **Rav Moshe** in 37) (אגרו"מ (יו"ד ח"ג-לא) *passkins* that pasteurized wine does qualify as *mevushal*, since it reaches 165°F, which is well above *yad soledes bo* (as Rav Belsky above writes that *yad soledes bo* is 160°F). Furthermore, Rav Moshe suggests that even according to the ש"ך, who defines “*mevushal*” as reducing the volume of the wine, such reduction may already begin at temperatures less than *yad soledes bo*. **Rav Ovadya** in 38) (יביע אומר (ח"ח יו"ד-טו) also *passkins* that *lema'ase*, pasteurized wine is considered *mevushal*, though he adds that those who are stringent should be blessed.

Some bottles of wine and grape juice sold in Israel have an additional line beneath the *hechsher* stating, “מבושל על ידי פיסטור” – “cooked through pasteurization,” in order to inform consumers that although the wine is pasteurized, it is not considered *mevushal* according to RSZA, Rav Elyashiv, and the אור לציון. *Lema'ase*, the regular

rabbanut hechsher considers pasteurization as *mevushal*, but the *mehadrin rabbanut hechsher* does not consider pasteurization as *bishul*.

The OU *passkins* in accordance with Rav Belsky's understanding of Rav Moshe that *le'chatchilla*, wine is only considered *mevushal* when it reaches a temperature of 175°F (79.4°C). Therefore, the OU will only label a wine bottle as "*mevushal*" if it is pasteurized (or otherwise heated) to that temperature (which is slightly above the standard pasteurization temperature). See the OU's position here: bit.ly/mevushalwine. Regarding Kedem grape juice (which is also subject to the prohibition of *stam yeinam*), the *hashgacha* is given both by the Tzelemer Rav as well as the OU, and the Tzelemer Rav holds that pasteurization must reach 190°F for the wine to be considered *mevushal*.

To summarize:

- Chazal allowed both drinking and benefiting from *mevushal* wine that was touched by a non-Jew.
- Once wine already became forbidden because it was touched or owned by a non-Jew (i.e., *stam yeinam*), cooking it will not remove the prohibition.
- There are several explanations as to why Chazal permitted drinking *mevushal* wine, even though the concern of intermarriage would seemingly still apply:
 - רא"ש – *mevushal* wine was uncommon, and Chazal generally did not prohibit uncommon occurrences. Although today *mevushal* wine is common, RSZA explains that it nevertheless remains permitted because we cannot add to the original *gezeirah* (though Rav Elyashiv seems to disagree).
 - רמב"ן – *mevushal* wine is no longer considered wine.
 - רע"א – Chazal only forbade deriving benefit from Jewish-owned wine touched by a non-Jew because of *יין נסך*, but not due to concern for intermarriage. Therefore, *mevushal* wine of a Jew touched by a non-Jew may be drunk because a non-Jew would not offer it for libation and there is no concern of intermarriage. However, *stam yeinam* was also forbidden because it will lead to intermarriage and therefore, *mevushal stam yeinam* (i.e., wine owned by a non-Jew) may not be drunk because of the concern for intermarriage.
- The definition of "*mevushal*" is wine that was heated to the temperature at which some evaporation occurs and the volume is slightly reduced.

- Most *posskim* understand that this is achieved when the wine reaches the temperature of *yad soledes bo*, but *posskim* disagree regarding the specific temperature today (ranging from 160°-190° F).
- There is a dispute whether pasteurization qualifies as *mevushal*.

F. Wine Mixtures

In this section, we will learn the *halachos* of a non-Jew touching wine that has been mixed with other ingredients. For example, what is the *halacha* if a non-Jew touches wine mixed with honey, a salad dressing containing wine, chocolate bars made with wine, or a mixture of *mevushal* and non-*mevushal* wine? Furthermore, what is the status of wine touched by a non-Jew whose texture has changed, such as frozen wine? To answer these questions, we will learn יו"ד סימן קכג סעיפים ד-ה from their earliest sources to the modern day *posskim*.

The 39) (גמרא עבודה זרה (ל) teaches that both *mevushal* wine of a non-Jew (i.e., a non-Jew cooking his wine) and אלונית, wine with a mixture of other ingredients, that was purchased from a non-Jew are forbidden. Rashi explains that the reason in both cases is because the wine was already prohibited before it was cooked or mixed with other ingredients. However, if Jewish wine was cooked, or if the אלונית was purchased from a Jew (so that the wine never became forbidden), even if they are later touched by a non-Jew, they both remain permitted, since both would never be offered for libation. Tosfos ד"ה אלונית writes that according to Rashi, whenever wine is mixed with other ingredients, it is no longer considered wine, and it remains permitted if a non-Jew subsequently touches it.

The 40) (בית יוסף) writes that the majority of the *posskim* understand that when a non-Jew touches אלונית (wine mixed with other ingredients), the wine mixture may even be drunk.¹ He explains that although Rashi uses the phrase “permitted to benefit from,” implying that drinking is forbidden, Rashi agrees that it may even be drunk. He explains that the reason for Rashi’s formulation is to teach that when the ברייתא forbids אלונית of a non-Jew in its first statement, it is even forbidden to benefit from it.

¹ Why would it be permitted to drink? Granted it would not be offered for libation, and therefore, benefit is permitted from it, but shouldn’t drinking it be prohibited because it can lead to intermarriage? The answer is similar to how we explained *mevushal* wine, that the moment the extra ingredients are added and the flavor changes, it is no longer considered wine and not included at all in the *gezeirah*.

The 41) **טור** defines **אלונתית**, based on the continuation of the above Gemara, as being aged wine mixed with clear water and balsam oil, and **ייןמולין**, which is mentioned by the Gemara together with **אלונתית**, as wine mixed with honey and pepper. The **טור** rules that if either is subsequently touched by a non-Jew, it remains permitted. He quotes the **רשב"א**, who maintains that as long as the flavor of the wine changes due to the added ingredients, the mixture is permitted.

The S"A in **סעיף ד'** *passkins* that if a non-Jew touches Jewish-owned wine that had previously been mixed with honey and pepper (**ייןמולין**), and the taste has changed, it does not become forbidden because it would never be offered for libation. The *Rama* adds that even if only honey or only pepper is added, as long as the taste of wine has changed, it is not prohibited when subsequently touched by a non-Jew. The **ש"ך** (ח) extends this principle to any added ingredient that changes the wine's flavor.

The S"A in **סעיף ה'** *passkins* that a dish containing wine that was touched by a non-Jew is permitted, even if the dish was not cooked. The *Rama* explains that this is true as long as the wine is properly mixed and not clearly visible, or even if it is visible, but the flavor has changed due to the other ingredients. Therefore, if a non-Jew touches a salad dressing of wine mixed with oil, where the wine has separated and risen to the top, the dressing is prohibited, since the wine is clearly visible – unless the flavor of the wine has changed (as we learned in **סעיף ד'**, that when the wine's flavor changes because of added ingredients, it does not become forbidden when subsequently touched by a non-Jew).

The *Rama* adds three other *halachos*: 1) If non-*mevushal* wine was mixed with *mevushal* wine and then touched by a non-Jew, some say the *mevushal* wine has the status of water, and later, in **סעיף ח'**, the *Rama passkins* that if the ratio of wine to water is 1:6 (one part wine to six parts water), the mixture is permitted (see **ש"ך** ט). Similarly, here, if the ratio of non-*mevushal* wine to *mevushal* wine is 1:6 (one part non-*mevushal* to six parts *mevushal*), it is permitted. However, the *Rama* records that some permit even with just a majority of *mevushal* wine. 2) Congealed (or frozen) wine touched by a non-Jew is permitted. 3) Pottery with wine absorbed in its walls which was touched by a non-Jew is permitted.

To summarize, wine touched by a non-Jew is permitted in the following cases:

- Wine whose flavor has been altered due to added ingredients
- Wine that has been mixed into food and is no longer discernible
 - If the wine is noticeable and the flavor has not changed, it is forbidden, but if the flavor is altered, it is permitted (*Rama*).

- Non-*mevushal* wine mixed with *mevushal* wine (if the *mevushal* wine has a ratio of 1:6, meaning one part *non-mevushal* to six parts *mevushal*, or according to some, even if it is just the majority).
- Frozen wine
- Absorbed wine in the walls of a jug of pottery

Practical Applications

Chocolate made with wine

Chocolate made with wine that was not cooked as part of the production process (e.g., it was added after the chocolate was melted and placed in a כלי שני) remains permitted if touched by a non-Jew. However, if the wine was touched by a non-Jew before it was mixed with the chocolate, it is certainly forbidden, since it already became prohibited and cannot become permitted by subsequent mixing with other ingredients.

Salad dressings and meat marinades

Some salad dressings contain wine. What is the *halacha* if a non-Jew touches the dressing, such as a cleaning lady or a non-Jewish chef at a kosher restaurant? The answer would depend on the appearance of the salad dressing. If the wine is mixed well and not noticeable, it is permitted. However, if the wine separates to the top (as is common when mixed with honey) and is clearly visible, it is only permitted if the flavor of the wine has been changed due to the other ingredients in the dressing.

Similarly, many meat marinades contain wine. If other ingredients are added that alter the taste of the wine, the marinade may be handled by a non-Jew. As mentioned in the previous subsection, here too, if the non-Jew touches the wine before it is mixed with the other ingredients, it is certainly forbidden.

Cake batter

Cake batter made with wine that was touched by a non-Jew is permitted because the flavor of wine was altered by the other ingredients (סעיף ד), and the wine was also mixed into the dish (סעיף ה). If the cake was already baked and then touched by a non-Jew, it is certainly permitted because the wine has now also become *mevushal*.

Frozen wine

Some cocktails are presented with frozen wine cubes for garnish and flair. The י"ד (42) (כהן – יעבדוך עמים (פכ"ז-ט) *passkins* based on the *Rama* that if your non-Jewish helper touched frozen wine in the ice cube tray, the wine is still permitted. However, once the cubes melt, it regains its regular status of wine and will become forbidden if

subsequently touched by a non-Jew. The question that remains open is whether the wine must fully melt before this applies, or whether it would already become forbidden if touched by a non-Jew after the ice is only partially melted and takes on a slushy consistency.

Pottery jugs

We learned above that according to the *Rama*, if a non-Jew touches a jug of pottery which absorbed kosher wine, the jug is still permitted. In contrast, the S"A in **גמרא עבודה זרה (כט) סעיף יג** *passkins*, based on the *stam yeinam* to the extent that if it would be soaked in water, it would release its absorbed wine, it is forbidden to derive benefit from the jug in any way. The **(ש"ך) (כה)** explains that in such a case, one may not even use a broken piece of the jug to balance a wobbly bed or table, and certainly the jug may not be used to store fruit.

The 43) **(פרישה) (ל)** asks: what is the difference between *stam yeinam* absorbed in an earthenware jug, in which case it is forbidden to derive benefit from the pot itself, and *basar b'chalav*² absorbed in a pot, in which case the S"A **ג-ד** *passkins* that the pot may be used to store fruit (and certainly to balance a wobbly bed)? The **פרישה** offers two possible distinctions: 1) Wine absorbed in earthenware vessels is desirable by the owner because it strengthens the vessel, whereas the absorption of *basar b'chalav* is unwanted by the owner. 2) The jug with absorbed wine referred to in the case of the S"A will eventually be used to store water. The absorbed wine flavor will enhance the taste of the water, and is therefore desired by the owner. Once the jug is forbidden because of the above reasons, it remains forbidden even if it breaks.³ However, according to the *Rama* in **א' סעיף א'**, who allows benefitting from *stam yeinam* today in a *be'dieved* situation, it would seem that one is allowed to use a broken piece of pottery to balance the bed.

² Like with *stam yeinam*, there is also a prohibition of benefiting from *basar b'chalav*.

³ This **פרישה** seems to contradict the S"A in **סימן קלז-ד**, who permits placing water, beer, and other beverages in clean non-kosher *keilim* used for *stam yeinam*. The **ש"ך** there explains that adding water/beer or other beverages is permitted because the flavor of wine is nullified by the water/beer, but the **פרישה** is referring to a case where you prefer the flavor of the wine in the water/beer. See also **קלה-ד**, where the S"A teaches that in order to *kasher* pottery vessels used for *stam yeinam*, you need to fill them up and empty them three times in three days.

G. Sherry Cask Whiskey – Reasons to Forbid

In the previous section, we learned that it is forbidden to benefit from a pottery jug that absorbed *stam yeinam*. Furthermore, we saw the explanation of the פרישה that when the jug is filled with water, the water absorbs the wine flavor from the walls of the jug and becomes forbidden. In the next two sections, we will learn the *sugya* of whiskey aged in sherry casks (barrels previously used to make non-kosher wine) and whether such whiskey is permitted for consumption.

In order to best understand this *sugya*, we will first learn how whiskey is produced and aged in sherry casks. Then we will learn four *halachic* principles that seem to prohibit the consumption of sherry cask whiskey, followed by possible ways to resolve these issues, and finally the *pssak* of contemporary *posskim*.

Whiskey is a distilled alcoholic beverage made from fermented grain mash. The grains used may include barley, corn, rye, and wheat. After fermentation and distillation, the liquid is initially clear (similar to the color of vodka), and is then typically aged in wooden barrels — usually oak barrels — which gives the whiskey its color and complex flavors. Scotch, bourbon, Irish whiskey, and Japanese whiskey are all forms of whiskey, and they get their names based on the location they are produced and their ingredients.

There are strict regulations regarding labeling whiskey as scotch or bourbon. For example, whiskey may only be labeled as scotch if it is produced in Scotland, contains no added flavors, sweeteners, herbs, or non-whiskey ingredients, and is aged for at least three years. The only additives allowed are water and caramel coloring (E150a). Bourbon must be produced in the USA, contain at least 51% corn, be aged in new charred oak barrels, and may contain no additives whatsoever. All the standard ingredients used in scotch and bourbon are kosher, but some cheaper whiskey products or spirit drinks may contain additional ingredients, sometimes even wine.⁴

See **video** on how whiskey is produced and how aging it in wooden barrels affects its color and taste: bit.ly/SCPwhiskey.

There are two⁵ major issues that can potentially forbid whiskey halachically: 1) Adding wine directly to the whiskey. 2) Aging the whiskey in barrels previously used for storing *stam yeinam*, such as sherry casks. Sherry is a type of wine produced in a specific

⁴ However, in countries such as Japan, Ireland, and others, there is no regulation and one would surely need a *hechsher*.

⁵ If the whiskey is owned by Jews, there is also an issue of חמץ שעבר עליו הפסח.

triangular region in Spain, and many whiskeys are aged in used sherry barrels. Whiskey may also be aged in barrels that previously held Port, Cognac, Madeira, Oloroso, Sauternes, Shiraz, or other wine-based products. Labels with terms such as “Dual-Cask Finish” or “Double-Matured” may indicate aging in wine casks, meaning that the whiskey may potentially contain absorbed *stam yeinam* flavor.

As mentioned above, in order to determine whether these types of whiskey may be consumed, we will learn four *halachic* principles that seem to prohibit sherry casks and then see how the *Acharonim* attempt to address each issue. It is important to note that the *sugya* of whiskey aged in sherry casks is quite extensive. We will learn the main concerns and solutions, but much more can be discussed, and one should consult his Rav for practical guidance.

I. Bitul with *stam yeinam*

The first issue we need to discuss is whether the wine flavor absorbed in the sherry casks is *batel* in the whiskey. In general, when a forbidden substance becomes mixed with a permitted one, the mixture is permitted if the forbidden ingredient is *batel b'shishim*. However, the 44) (עג.) (משנה עבודה זרה) *passkins* that if even the smallest amount of יין נסך gets mixed with other wine (מין במינו), the mixture becomes forbidden. If the יין נסך is mixed with other drinks (מין בשאינו מינו), the mixture is forbidden only if the flavor of the wine is detectable. The majority of *Rishonim*, including the רמב"ן (ד"ה רמב"ן), *passkin* (רמב"ם) (מאכלות אסורות פט"ז-כט) and the (רשב"א) (תורת הבית שער ה נט זז), the גט, the same rules apply to *stam yeinam*. Thus, when kosher wine becomes mixed with non-kosher wine, even the smallest amount of non-kosher wine forbids the mixture, but when non-kosher wine is mixed with other beverages, the mixture is only forbidden if the wine flavor is noticeable.

When wine mixes with whiskey—whether by being added directly or through absorption from sherry casks—it is considered מין בשאינו מינו and can be subject to *bitul*. The question is: what amount of whiskey is needed to nullify the wine?

The 45) (טור (קלד) writes that *shishim* is required, just like any other mixture. But the רמב"ן *passkins* that the non-kosher wine is *batel* in a ratio of 1:6, since that is the point at which wine loses its identity when diluted with water. The S"A in 46) (סימן קלד-ה) *passkins* like the רמב"ן that a ratio of 1:6 suffices. The *Rama* in our *siman*, סימן קכג-ח, cites both opinions, and the (ש"ך) (טז) explains that the *Rama passkins* like the S"A.

However, the *Rama* in 47) (סימן קיד-ו) *passkins* that when purchasing beer from non-Jews, one must ensure that no wine was added. If wine was mixed in, it must be *batel b'shishim*, and even then, the beer is only permitted if the wine does not add flavor

and enhance the beer. The *ט"ז* (ס"ק"ד, ו) writes that the *Rama* is quoting the *מרדכי* who requires *shishim*, but we follow the opinion that *stam yeinam* is *batel* in a ratio of 1:6. The *ש"ך* (נקודת הכסף), however, defends the written *pssak* of the *Rama* and explains that the leniency of 1:6 applies only when non-kosher wine is mixed with **water**, but if the *stam yeinam* is mixed with other drinks, *shishim* is required.

What emerges from here is that according to the *S"A* and *ט"ז*, wine flavor absorbed in whiskey is *batel* in a ratio of 1:6, but the *ש"ך* would require *shishim*. However, even according to the *S"A*, there still appears to be an issue, because the whiskey does not contain six times the volume of the walls of the casks. The walls of a sherry cask (which absorbed the wine) are about 2 inches thick (or 5.1 cm), and 6 times their volume (including the lid and bottom of the barrel) would not fit inside the barrel itself.⁶ Thus, even according to the *S"A* and *ט"ז*, (that only 1:6 is required), when whiskey is aged in sherry casks, the absorbed sherry is not *batel* because the whiskey is not six times the volume of the barrel.

However, this may not be an issue because the *S"A* in 48) (סימן קלה-יג) *passkins* that when wine is absorbed into the walls of a barrel through soaking, it only absorbs a *כדי קליפה*, since no heat was involved. Therefore, the whiskey would certainly contain six times the volume of *כדי קליפה* of the barrel, and perhaps even *shishim* against it.⁷ However, the *ש"ך* there qualifies that the case of the *S"A* is where it is uncertain how long the wine was soaked in the barrel. But if it was certainly soaked for at least 24 hours, then it would have the status of *כבישה* (*halachic* soaking, when the liquid is in a solid container for over 24 hours), in which case the wine is absorbed into the entire thickness of the barrel. Therefore, in our case of the sherry casks, even the opinions that only require a ratio of 1:6 would agree that the sherry flavor is not *batel* since the barrel does not hold 6 times the thickness of its walls.

To summarize, according to the *ש"ך*, *stam yeinam* absorbed in the walls of a barrel is only *batel* if there is *shishim* against the full thickness of the walls of the barrel. According to the simple reading of *S"A* and the *ט"ז*, only six times the amount of wine

⁶ According to ChatGPT, the total volume of all the wood in the cask, including staves and heads, is approximately 0.173 cubic meters (or 173 liters, or 6.1 cubic feet). This accounts for the 30–36 oak staves (each ~30 mm thick, 12 cm wide, 1.3 m long) and two circular heads (each ~30 mm thick, 0.7 m diameter). A sherry butt (another name for cask) has a nominal capacity of ~500 liters (0.5 cubic meters) for liquid storage. 6 times 173 liters (the volume of the barrel) is 1038 and does not fit in the 500 liter barrel.

⁷ Although, as we saw, the *S"A* in קכ"ג forbids even benefiting from an earthenware jug that was used for *stam yeinam*, that appears to be a special *din* relating to earthenware vessels, which naturally absorb significant amounts of liquid. In that case, the jug has absorbed so much wine that when it is filled with water, the water changes color. However, wooden casks or other *keilim* are permitted, as is evident from the *S"A* in קל"ד, who permits placing water, beer, and other beverages in *keilim* that were previously used for *stam yeinam*. See ר"ת quoted in Tosfos עב: ד"ה אם עבודה זרה who writes that pottery absorbs much more than wood.

absorbed in the כדי קליפה of the barrel is needed. Furthermore, even if we are lenient like the S"A/ר"ט that only six times the absorbed wine is needed, six times the volume of the barrel is still necessary according to the ר"ש's understanding of the S"A, which is not present in thick sherry casks.

Based on all this, it would seem at first glance that according to the S"A and ר"ט, the wine flavor in sherry casks is *batel*, whereas according to the ר"ש, it would not be *batel*. Therefore, in order to decide whether whiskey in sherry casks is kosher, we would need to first determine who we *passkin* like. However, in the next subsection, we will see that even according to the S"A and ר"ט, *bitul* may not help because the wine contributes noticeable flavor.

II. Spices added for flavor are not *batel*

Although the S"A *passkins* that wine becomes *batel* in a ratio of 1:6, in this subsection we will learn that when a forbidden ingredient is added specifically for its flavor, it is not *batel* even in 1,000. Therefore, sherry cask whiskey should still be forbidden because the sherry flavor is detectable in the whiskey.

The *Rama* in צח-ח and in 47) (קידו-ו), as well as the S"A in או"ח תקיג-ג, *passkin* based on the (צ) (גמרא חולין) and the רשב"א/רא"ש that when a forbidden ingredient is added to a mixture to impart flavor, and the substance is inherently forbidden in its own right (as opposed to prohibitions that arise only from the combination of two otherwise permitted items, such as *basar b'chalav*), it is not *batel* even in 1,000. Rather, it remains prohibited as long as its flavor is detectable. Accordingly, sherry cask whiskey should be prohibited since the whiskey is aged in these barrels specifically to absorb the sherry flavor.

III. Ingredients added for color are not *batel*

The *Rama* in קב-א and the S"A in 49) (או"ח סימן תקיג-ג) *passkin* that whenever an ingredient is added to provide color, it is never *batel*. One of the main reasons whiskey is aged in sherry casks is to give it a darker color. Therefore, sherry cask whiskey should be forbidden for this reason as well.

IV. *Bitul le'chatchilla*

The S"A in 50) (סימן צטו-ו) *passkins* that one may not deliberately nullify even a rabbinic prohibition, and if one does so, he may not benefit from the resulting mixture. Thus, even if the wine absorbed in the sherry casks is *batel*, it would still seem to be forbidden to deliberately produce, or possibly even purchase, whiskey that was aged in sherry casks, since one is deliberately relying on *bitul*.

What emerges from all of the above is that there are 4 main reasons to prohibit sherry cask whiskey.

1. According to the ש"ש, the *stam yeinam* absorbed in the walls of the barrel is not *batel* because *shishim* is required in the whiskey against the thickness of the barrel walls, which is not the case. According to the S"A and ט"ז, only a ratio of 1:6 is needed to be *mevatel* the *stam yeinam*, and only against the כדי קליפה of the barrel. However, even according to their position, the ש"ש *passkins* that 6 times the thickness of the entire barrel is necessary.
2. Even according to the S"A, a forbidden ingredient intentionally added for flavor is not *batel* even in 1,000 if the flavor is detectable, and the sherry flavor is clearly tasted in the whiskey.
3. Anything intentionally added for color is not *batel*, and sherry casks significantly affect the whiskey's color.
4. Purchasing whiskey aged in sherry casks requires deliberately relying on *bitul*, which seems comparable to deliberately nullifying a prohibition.